

NitroStack × Amrita University Hackathon

Do's & Don'ts for Participants

DO's

Before You Start

Before the hackathon begins, every participant should have a basic understanding of:

- [Model Context Protocol \(MCP\) | MCP in 25 minutes](#)
- [GitHub Deploy](#)
- [Nodejs InstallDeploy with Github.mp4](#)
- [Starter App with NitroStack](#)
- [NitroStack Platform](#) |
- [NitroStack TypeScript SDK](#)
- [NitroStack Docs](#)

A basic understanding of these technologies will allow you to spend your time building instead of configuring your environment.

- Ensure your development environment is fully set up with:
 - Node.js (Latest LTS)
 - Git
 - GitHub Account
 - TypeScript
 - NitroStack TypeScript SDK
 - npm or pnpm
 - Visual Studio Code (Recommended)
- Verify that you can:
 - Clone a GitHub repository
 - Install dependencies
 - Run a TypeScript project
 - Build an MCP Server locally using NitroStack
 - Push code to GitHub
 - Access Discord on your system throughout the hackathon.

Idea Selection

- Be clear and confident about the idea you choose before you begin development.
 - Put the ideas in markdowns before beginning.
 - Ensure your project idea aligns with one of the **six official hackathon tracks**. •
- Validate your idea with your teammates early so you can maximize your development time.

💡💡 Development

- Build your entire project using the **official NitroStack TypeScript SDK**.
- Ensure your solution aligns with one of the official hackathon tracks.
- Use NitroStack throughout the complete development lifecycle—from development and testing to deployment and final submission.
- Build your MVP (Minimum Viable Product) first, then continue improving it with additional features.
- Keep your code modular, clean, and easy to understand.

☁️ Deployment

- Deploy your project to **NitroStack Cloud** as soon as you have a working prototype. •
- Continue pushing updates to GitHub so NitroStack Cloud can automatically redeploy your latest changes.
- Test every deployment to catch issues early instead of waiting until the final submission.
 - Validate your deployed application after every major milestone.

💡💡 GitHub Best Practices

- Commit your code frequently with meaningful commit messages.
- Push your latest changes regularly.
- Keep your default branch stable and deployable.
- Include a well-written README explaining:
 - Project overview
 - Installation steps
 - Environment setup
 - Architecture

- Usage instructions
- Organize your repository so judges can easily understand your project.
- Use a proper `.gitignore` file and not delete the file or its content.

💡💡 AI Usage

- Use the provided **5 Million AI Tokens** responsibly.
- Use AI for:
 - Debugging
 - Refactoring
 - Prompt optimization
 - Testing
- Make sure you understand every piece of code you include in your project.

💡💡 Testing

- Test your MCP Server regularly.
- Verify that:
 - MCP resources work correctly.
 - NitroStack Studio work correctly
 - Tools execute successfully.
 - Dependencies install correctly.
 - Deployment succeeds.
 - Your application works end-to-end.
- Fix bugs as you go instead of saving everything for the last few hours.

💡💡 Getting Help

- Read the provided resources before asking for help.
- Discuss with your teammates first.
- If you're still blocked, ask your question to the assigned volunteers.

💡💡 Before Submission

- Ensure your project is successfully deployed on NitroStack Cloud.
- Push the latest version of your code to GitHub.

- Submit your project to the official Sample Apps repository on GitHub
- Verify that your repository is complete and accessible.
- Follow the demo video reference/guidelines provided in the submission portal and record a demo video (maximum 3 minutes) explaining:
 - The problem statement
 - Your solution
 - A working demonstration of your project
- Submit your project through the official NitroStack Cloud Dashboard using the organizer-provided account.

💡💡 Social Media

- Coordinate with the NitroStack social media team whenever they approach your team for photos, videos, interviews, or demos.
- Be prepared to briefly explain your project, the problem you're solving, and what makes it unique.
- Help us capture your building journey and showcase your work to the wider developer community.

❌ DON'Ts

💡💡 Technology

- Don't use any SDK other than the **official NitroStack TypeScript SDK**. • Don't build your project using unsupported frameworks or SDKs if you expect deployment on NitroStack Cloud.

💡💡 Idea Selection

- Don't spend several hours trying to come up with the "perfect" idea.

💡💡 Deployment

- Don't wait until the last hour to deploy your application.

- Don't assume your project will work in production without testing.
- Don't submit a project that hasn't been deployed successfully.

💡💡 GitHub & Security

- Never upload:
 - API Keys
 - Access Tokens
 - Passwords
 - Credentials
 - `.env` files
- Never commit `node_modules` or secrets into github.
- Don't upload unnecessary large files or binaries.
- Don't make your repository private before judging is complete.
- Don't leave broken or incomplete code in your main branch.

💡💡 AI Usage

- Don't ask AI to generate your complete project.
- Don't rely entirely on AI-generated code without understanding it.
- Don't blindly copy and paste code from AI.

💡💡 Development

- Don't start coding before understanding the problem statement.
- Don't spend most of your time polishing the UI while ignoring core functionality.
- Don't skip testing.
- Don't ignore deployment until the end.
- Don't forget to push your latest changes to GitHub.

💡💡 Communication

- Don't spam mentors or repeatedly tag multiple volunteers.
- Don't send direct messages to mentors unless they specifically ask you to.
- Don't ask questions without first checking the documentation or Discord discussions.

◆◆ Social Media

- Don't refuse when the social media team approaches you for content.
- Don't hesitate to explain your project, it's an opportunity to showcase your work.

◆◆ Submission

- Don't submit incomplete documentation.
- Don't forget your README or installation instructions.
- Don't leave environment variables undocumented.
- Don't submit a project that hasn't been tested.
- Don't forget to upload your demo video.
- Don't submit through any account other than the one provisioned by the organizers.